Two stories of resilience

White standard edition

Story A Nehemiah and the wall

Nehemiah heard that the walls around his people’s city were broken. He felt sad and prayed to God. He wanted to help the community. He asked for support, made a plan and checked what needed to be done.

Many people joined the work. Different groups worked on different parts of the wall. It was a large, hard task. Nehemiah encouraged the workers. They worked together and kept going until the wall was finished.

Some Jewish readers may see prayer, planning and shared work as sources of strength. The story can show that resilience includes accepting help.

An original simple retelling of part of the Book of Nehemiah in the Hebrew Bible, used here as a Jewish sacred-text story. Christians also read this book. No scripture wording is reproduced.

Find and think

Who kept going?
What helped them?
What might the story teach?

Two stories of resilience continued

White standard edition

Story B Ayyub asks for help

The Qur’an tells of Ayyub, a prophet who faced hardship. He spoke to Allah about his suffering and asked for help. The text presents him as patient: he continued to turn to Allah during a very hard time.

In the story, Allah answered Ayyub and brought him relief. Many Muslims look to Ayyub as an example of patience and trust. Asking for help did not cancel his patience.

Some Muslims may find hope in this story when life is difficult. It does not mean every hardship will end in the same way, or that people should face problems without support.

An original simple retelling of part of the Qur’an’s account of Ayyub, a sacred-text story in Islam. No scripture wording is reproduced.

Find and think

Who kept going?
What helped him?
What might the story teach?